

Crafting Core (DnD 5e)

Complete Manual - v0.5.5

Hammer-PvP

Foundry VTT 14 / D&D 5e 5.3.3

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1 What Crafting Core Is

Crafting Core is a GM-authoritative crafting, harvesting, material, Recipe Knowledge, and portable Recipe framework for Foundry Virtual Tabletop. It is built specifically for D&D 5e and uses native D&D5e Items as ingredients and outputs.

The core game loop is:

1. Materials exist in a private World Compendium and can come from creature harvest, environmental gathering, game hunting, mining, cultivation, processing, vendors, or other configured sources.
2. The GM creates or installs Recipes.
3. Recipes are published as Knowledge Source Items in a private Compendium.
4. Characters learn Recipes from those Items.
5. Characters craft through their sheet using timed crafts or persistent Crafting Projects.
6. Crafted outputs are complete Item snapshots, so other D&D5e automation can continue working normally.

Crafting Core deliberately separates authoring, publication, Character knowledge, active Projects, and generated loot so one layer can be changed without silently rewriting another.

2 Compatibility and Optional Integrations

2.1 Foundry and D&D5e

- Crafting Core: **v0.5.5**
- Foundry VTT: minimum 14; verified 14.365
- D&D 5e: **5.3.3**

Crafting Core is version-bound to the D&D5e system version it was built and tested against.

2.2 Item Piles

Item Piles is optional. When available, Crafting Core can create Hidden Item Piles from generated loot and can use Item Piles as the physical container for Token Harvest results. Crafting Core remains responsible for harvest rules and generated material selection.

2.3 DnD 5e Item Creator

The core Crafting Core framework does not require Item Creator. The existing official persistent Curated Food/Alcohol library uses the established Item Creator integration documented by the module. The optional Alchemy & Inscription library introduced in v0.5.5 does **not** require premium Player's Handbook Item content; canonical consumables are resolved from D&D5e SRD 5.2 / SRD 5.1 only.

3 Managed Compendiums

Crafting Core uses three private World Compendiums as durable content stores and interoperability boundaries.

3.1 Crafting Core - Materials

The core catalog contains **234 built-in Materials**. Installing the optional Alchemy & Inscription library activates **23 additional Materials**, producing **257 active built-ins**.

Material Items carry stable Crafting Core identities. Recipes should reference the stable Material identity rather than relying only on a World-specific UUID.

3.2 Crafting Core - Learn Sources

Published Recipe, Formula, Blueprint, and Manual Items live here. This Compendium is the authoritative published Knowledge database.

A Learn Source contains the frozen Recipe definition and a native D&D5e **Learn Recipe** Activity. Distributed copies teach the stable Recipe identity to a Character.

3.3 Crafting Core - Products

This shared private Products Compendium contains official Curated Products and imported custom results.

The standard Curated Culinary library contains **58 Products**. When optional Alchemy & Inscription is installed, it adds **82 Products**, for **140 Curated Products total**:

- 43 SRD-based alchemical consumables;
- 34 Inscription presentation variants;
- 5 Inscription Inks.

4 Opening Crafting Core

The GM opens Crafting Core from the Item Directory button. Players use the Crafting tab on eligible Character sheets.

The GM application provides Recipe authoring, Knowledge management, material generation, Creature Scanner/Harvest Profile management, and links to the Materials & Products catalog.

5 Recipe Drafts and the Recipe Builder

5.1 Creating a Draft

A Builder Draft is private GM authoring state. **Save Draft** saves the draft only; it does not change any published source that players may already possess.

A Recipe can define:

- name and description;
- timed crafting or persistent Project mode;
- eligible Tool/Skill proficiencies;
- who may attempt the craft;
- automatic success for qualified crafters;
- progress checks and Extra Effort;
- Final Crafting Check behavior;
- Player Visibility rules;
- ingredient Item references and quantities;
- a complete output Item snapshot;
- Knowledge Source type: Recipe, Formula, Blueprint, or Manual.

5.2 Proficiency and Final Check

Proficiency 1 is the primary/default eligible option. Proficiency 2 is an alternative eligible option. The configured proficiency rule determines whether either or both are needed.

A common Curated pattern is:

- Who Can Attempt: Anyone;
- Proficiency Match: Any one qualifies;
- Proficient Policy: Automatic final success;
- non-qualified crafter: may still attempt and rolls the configured final check.

When a roll is required and two eligible proficiencies exist, the crafter chooses which one to use before starting. A Project freezes that choice in its snapshot.

5.3 Ingredients

Crafting Core supports both Base Item and Exact Item identity.

- **Base Item match** is appropriate for generic canonical equipment families.
- **Exact Item** is appropriate for Crafting Core Materials, managed Products, specific custom/Item Creator derivatives, and other intentionally unique ingredients.

5.4 Output

The Result Item is stored as a complete snapshot. Quantity is explicit, so one Recipe can craft a batch while the Product itself remains an individually priced Item.

6 Timed Crafting

Timed crafting validates access and inventory, consumes the configured ingredients, uses synchronized server time for the configured duration, and creates the frozen output Item when the craft finishes.

7 Crafting Projects

Projects are persistent work across rests.

7.1 Starting a Project

Starting reserves the required ingredients and immediately performs the first normal Work Attempt. The Project stores a frozen Recipe snapshot so later Recipe edits do not rewrite work already in progress.

7.2 Work Periods and Rest Cadence

A Project may require multiple Work Periods. Short Rest or Long Rest can be configured as the cadence that unlocks the next normal Work Attempt. A rest does not add progress by itself.

7.3 Progress Checks

Projects can make Ability, Skill, Tool, or Saving Throw checks every Work Period or at the midpoint. Failure can produce no progress, regress progress, or fail the Project depending on Recipe data.

7.4 Extra Effort

Extra Effort is an optional second attempt in the same work cycle. It never consumes the Recipe's materials again. It can use a separate check and DC.

For Curated Inscription Projects in v0.5.5, Extra Effort uses **INT DC 12**. A successful Extra Effort adds **+1 additional progress** beyond the normal Work Period, producing two total progress for that cycle. Failure grants no extra progress and does not erase the normal +1.

7.5 Final Crafting Check

The Final Crafting Check runs after required work is complete when the Recipe requires it. Curated Alchemy & Inscription uses DC 8 for non-qualified crafters. Qualified crafters use Automatic Success. Curated failure behavior can fail the attempt and lose approximately 50 percent of the attempt's Materials.

8 Publication and Knowledge Lifecycle

8.1 Save Draft

Saves only private GM Builder state.

8.2 Publish to Private Compendium

Creates the authoritative Knowledge Source Item in **Crafting Core - Learn Sources**.

8.3 Update Published Source

Updates the same managed Knowledge Source identity. Characters who know the Recipe are reconciled from the persisted published source rather than from an unsaved Builder draft.

8.4 Knowledge Base

The Knowledge Base manages real published Compendium Items. It can open the source, continue editing as a draft, show pending unpublished changes, and Unpublish with confirmation.

8.5 Learn, Unlearn, and Unpublish

- **Learn Recipe** teaches the stable Recipe to one Character.
- **Unlearn** removes it from that Character only.
- **Unpublish** removes the global authoritative source and reconciles Character knowledge.
- active Projects remain valid because they use frozen snapshots.

9 Recipe Transfer Between Worlds

Recipe Transfer is a GM-only workflow under Game Settings -> Crafting Core.

Exports include the Recipe definition plus a complete Result Item snapshot, including Activities, Effects, flags, output quantity, and ingredient identity metadata.

Canonical Crafting Core Materials resolve in the destination World by stable Material ID. Generic D&D Base Items retain Base Item matching, while exact custom dependencies remain exact. Imports are previews first and never publish automatically.

Imported custom Result Items are placed in **Crafting Core - Products -> Custom Items**. Official Curated Products are never overwrite targets for imported custom content.

10 Materials Catalog

10.1 Families and Organization

Materials cover Creature Harvest, Essences, Gathering, Profession & Trade, Food/Cooking, metalworking, leather-working, alchemy, and general resources.

10.2 Rarity Economy

Each Material has rarity, value, drop chance, quantity formula, category/tags, and source metadata. Recipe difficulty should normally come from material availability, rarity gates, workload, and cost rather than automatically increasing Final Check DC by rarity.

10.3 Material Sources

Source metadata distinguishes how a Material is obtained, for example:

- creature;
- gathering;
- mining;
- cultivated;
- processed;
- vendor.

`sourceType` describes the acquisition route. Creature size is a signal, not a source type.

Gathering Materials can show ordered **Found In** biomes. Creature Harvest Materials can show World-specific **Harvested From** Actor links built from Harvest Profiles using real document UUIDs.

10.4 Resync / Rebuild Material Sources

Material Sources Resync performs a full reverse-index rebuild from current Harvest Profiles. It adds current Actor links and removes obsolete ones rather than appending forever.

10.5 Reset to Curated Defaults

Reset restores Crafting Core-managed curated fields without deleting GM custom Materials. In v0.5.5 it is designed to be idempotent and preserves World-derived Creature Sources and unrelated module flags. Repeating the Reset on an unchanged catalog should report zero restored entries.

11 Curated Culinary Products

The standard official library contains **58 Products**:

- 15 Meals;
- 28 Alcoholic Drinks;
- 15 Non-Alcoholic Drinks.

These Products are real D&D5e consumables intended for loot, vendors, drag-and-drop, Supplier-style stock, or Recipe outputs. Existing food/alcohol lifecycle, serving-yield economy, and replacement-family behavior are unchanged in v0.5.5.

12 Optional Curated Alchemy & Inscription

This library is **opt-in**. A World that does not install it remains on the core 234 Materials and 58 Curated Culinary Products.

Installation is available from Materials & Products -> Curated Products -> **Install / Restore Alchemy & Inscription**.

After successful installation the expected totals are:

Content	Optional library	Total active curated content
Materials	+23	257 built-in Materials
Products	+82	140 Curated Products
Alchemy/Inscription Recipe Learn Sources	97	97

12.1 SRD-only Product Policy

Canonical consumable Products are resolved at runtime only from installed D&D5e `dnd5e.equipment24` (SRD 5.2) and `dnd5e.items` (SRD 5.1) Items that identify the CC-BY-4.0 source.

Crafting Core does **not** bundle snapshots from premium Player's Handbook content.

The Product pipeline is intentionally simple:

1. resolve the canonical SRD Item;
2. call D&D5e's native Compendium conversion/import path;
3. persist the complete native Item in the Crafting Core Products Compendium;
4. validate that its native Activities survived;
5. only then apply optional Crafting Core presentation metadata.

For ordinary Products and Inscriptions, Crafting Core does not reconstruct or transplant `system.activities`.

Potion of Comprehension and Potion of Fire Breath are not distributed because the supplied D&D5e 5.3.3 SRD packs do not provide redistributable canonical Product Items for them.

12.2 Healing Traditions

All cultural methods produce the **same canonical SRD Potion**, not separate cultural potion mechanics.

Each of the four Healing tiers has Traditional, Elven, and Dwarven Recipes:

- Potion of Healing;
- Potion of Healing (Greater);
- Potion of Healing (Superior);
- Potion of Healing (Supreme).

The culture exists in ingredients and crafting flavor; the output remains the canonical Potion.

12.3 Inscription

An Inscription is a different crafting form and presentation for the same functional canonical consumable.

Example:

Potion of Healing (Greater) -> Greater Healing Inscription

The Inscription is still structurally the canonical potion Item, preserving native Activities and compatibility, but it receives a document-themed name/icon/flavor and a different Recipe.

Visual tiers:

- **Basic:** simple document/parchment presentation;
- **Elaborate:** more developed manuscript/multiple-page presentation;
- **Elite:** book/tome presentation.

Inscription crafting uses **Calligrapher's Supplies OR Arcana**. Ink crafting uses **Calligrapher's Supplies OR Alchemist's Supplies**.

12.4 Inscription Inks

Each Ink Recipe yields two units.

Ink	Alternative pigment A	Alternative pigment B
Common Inscription Ink	Wild Sage x5	Elvenleaf Herb x5
Uncommon Inscription Ink	Blackwater Flower x5	Ashen Lichen x5
Rare Inscription Ink	Blood Orchid x5	Starpetal x5
Very Rare Inscription Ink	Moon Orchid x5	Ghost Lotus x5
Legendary Inscription Ink	Worldroot Blossom x5	Astral Rose x5

12.5 Fixed Potion of Resistance Variants

The SRD **Potion of Resistance** is a template that determines a resistance type rather than a ready-made fixed Product. It is therefore the controlled exception to the ordinary clone-and-reskin rule.

Crafting Core:

1. imports the complete SRD template through the native pipeline;
2. keeps exactly one canonical `ActiveEffect` for the requested damage type;
3. edits the **existing native Utility Activity** through D&D5e's public Item Activity API;
4. removes the random resistance-table roll;
5. links the fixed `ActiveEffect`;
6. uses Self targeting and a specific description;

7. applies the fixed effect for **1 hour (3,600 seconds)** on use.

The library provides final Potion and Inscription variants for:

Acid, Cold, Fire, Force, Lightning, Necrotic, Poison, Psychic, Radiant, and Thunder.

A Fire Recipe therefore creates a **Potion of Fire Resistance**, not a generic potion that can later be changed into Cold or another resistance.

12.6 Optional Materials

The 23 newly activated Materials are:

Rarity	Materials
Uncommon	Regenerative Ichor; Venomous Ichor; Corrosive Ichor; Ooze Mucus; Feyheart Nectar; Moonmoss; Deepcap Fungus
Rare	Regenerative Tissue; Giant Heart; Vaporous Membrane; Blood Orchid; Starpetal; Deepheart Fungus
Very Rare	Regenerative Core; Titanic Core; Accelerated Heart; Aerial Heart; Moon Orchid; Ghost Lotus; Stoneheart Morel
Legendary	Primordial Giant Heart; Worldroot Blossom; Astral Rose

These are additions to the existing v0.4.2 catalog. Existing Materials such as Spider Silk, Giant Blood, Amphibious Membrane, Air Essence, Sugar Cane, and the elemental/energy Essences are reused rather than duplicated.

Adamantine Powder remains Very Rare. Its supported source routes are Mining, Processed, and Vendor, with Adamantine Ore recorded as a related processed origin. Crafting Core does not automatically create an Ore -> Powder Recipe.

12.7 Scanner and Installation Order

Creature Harvest Materials use data-driven Scanner v2 eligibility signals such as anatomy, creature type, attack terms, structural terms, ability scores, movement, and size. They are not hardcoded to a list of creature names.

Scanner automatic rarity pools can store up to **7 candidate Materials** in v0.5.5. This increases diversity in a larger catalog without increasing the number of final rarity-pool drops.

If a World installs Alchemy & Inscription **after** it has already scanned its Actor sources, run Creature Scanner once more. That lets the new Creature Harvest Materials enter World-specific Harvest Profiles. Then run Material Sources Resync normally.

13 Creature Scanner

Creature Scanner analyzes configured Actor Compendiums and creates/updates Harvest Profiles. The GM can include as many source Compendiums as desired; profiles use stable source identity and generic eligibility analysis.

Scanner logic distinguishes physical anatomy, creature nature/type, attacks/features, magical/elemental affinities, movement, size, and other signals. A signal can qualify a candidate without becoming a new **sourceType**.

14 Harvest Profiles

A profile contains:

- inferred anatomy and semantic signals;
- four automatic rarity pools: Common, Uncommon, Rare, Very Rare/Legendary;
- multiple candidates per pool;

- a separate fifth Essence Pool;
- chance and quantity rules;
- optional GM Pinpoint Overrides.

A successful rarity pool produces **one** selected Material from that pool. More candidates increase variety, not final drop count.

Pinpoint Overrides are separate extra rolls and do not consume a normal pool result.

15 Essence Pool

The fifth slot is reserved for Essence logic.

Actors with a valid elemental/energy affinity can yield the matching specific Essence or Arcane Essence. The distribution is intended to keep Arcane Essence broadly competitive with all specific Essences combined while making each individual specific Essence relatively scarce.

Actors with no valid affinity use the Arcane/no-Essence fallback behavior defined by the analyzer.

16 Generate Materials

Generate Materials supports:

- Creature Harvest;
- Environment Gathering;
- Game Hunt.

Generation is preview-first. The GM may edit generated quantities or remove a row from the current batch without changing the Material Catalog or source Profile.

Environment abundance controls discovery pressure and rarity mix rather than multiplying every stack quantity. The generated preview is the exact batch materialized to a World Item folder or optional Hidden Item Pile.

17 Token Harvest and Existing NPC Loot

When Item Piles is active, eligible dead Tokens can be harvested using their stored Harvest Profile.

Existing-NPC-loot handling supports:

- Normalize from Compendiums;
- Remove All Existing Items;
- Keep Physical Gear / Remove Natural & Features;
- Keep All Existing Items.

Normalization prefers safe exact/base matches. Optional firearm homebrew can normalize firearm gear to medieval crossbow families when enabled.

18 Game Settings

Game Settings -> Crafting Core includes:

- Creature Scanner source configuration and priority;
- Material Source resync;
- Token Harvest loot handling;
- gear normalization sources/priority;
- Recipe Transfer import/export;
- optional firearm normalization;
- Support the Creator and related Hammer-PvP module links.

19 Troubleshooting

19.1 Optional Alchemy catalog is not complete

Open Materials & Products -> Curated Products and use **Install / Restore Alchemy & Inscription**. The synchronizer processes every Product and reports a failure summary instead of stopping at the first failure. An incomplete library remains eligible for repair on the next sync.

Expected complete optional counts are **82 / 82 Products** and **97 / 97 Recipes**. Combined with the Culinary library, the Product catalog is **140 / 140**.

19.2 A canonical Product has no Activity

Alchemy v0.5.5 imports canonical Products through D&D5e's own Compendium conversion path and validates the persisted native Activity set. The ordinary Product pipeline never reconstructs Activities. If a Product still lacks an Activity, check the console for the named Product and its SRD source resolution.

19.3 A Resistance Potion rolls a random type

The final fixed Resistance Products should not roll the SRD resistance-type table. Re-run Install / Restore Alchemy & Inscription. A repaired fixed variant has a specific name/description, one matching resistance ActiveEffect, and a Utility Activity linked to that effect.

19.4 Material reset keeps changing entries

Run Reset to Curated Defaults a second time without editing the catalog. On an unchanged catalog the second pass should restore zero entries. Material Sources Resync is separate and may still update reverse Creature Source links when Harvest Profiles changed.

19.5 New Creature Materials are not linked to monsters

If the optional library was installed after the last Creature Scanner run, scan the configured Actor sources again, then use Material Sources Resync.

19.6 A Character sees an old Recipe

Published Recipe changes are authoritative only after Update Published Source. Active Projects intentionally retain the frozen Recipe snapshot with which they began.

20 Quick Reference

Task	Where
Create/edit Recipe	GM Crafting Core -> Recipe Builder
Publish Recipe	Builder footer -> Publish / Update Published Source
Manage published Recipes	Knowledge Base
Teach Recipe	Drag/use Learn Source Item
Craft	Character sheet -> Crafting
Sync core Materials	Materials -> Sync Catalog
Reset built-in Material defaults	Materials -> Reset to Curated Defaults
Install optional Alchemy	Curated Products -> Install / Restore Alchemy & Inscription
Open Products	Materials & Products -> Open Products Compendium
Rebuild creature source links	Configure Crafting Core -> Material Sources Resync
Scan creature Compendiums	Crafting Core -> Creature Scanner
Generate gathering/hunt loot	Crafting Core -> Generate Materials
Transfer Recipes	Game Settings -> Crafting Core -> Recipe Transfer

21 Project Links and Support

Repository: <https://github.com/hammer-PvP/Crafting-Core-DnD-5e>

Support: <https://buymeacoffee.com/hammer.pvp>

The repository README links directly to the current manual in `docs/Crafting-Core-Complete-Manual.pdf`.